

traveling opened his eyes to the fact there are many ways to live beyond what we think of as normal.

This was echoed by Brandon Pearce, who writes the blog *Pearce on Earth*. Brandon went from working as a call center technician to a location-independent entrepreneur. He started a software business serving music teachers. This allowed him to have a nomadic lifestyle, traveling the world with his wife and three children. He said, “I think the most powerful thing for me about travel is, or at least in the beginning stages was, just realizing that my way of doing things the way I’ve always done (them) isn’t necessarily the only right way to do things.” He added, “There are so many amazing, wonderful people out there doing things, thinking things, and believing things completely differently from me, yet they exude the same genuine humanity that I possess.”

I can relate to these sentiments. My wife and I began traveling extensively once we finished college. Our travels revolved around chasing our passion for outdoor adventure. This took us off the beaten tourist paths to areas plagued with poverty, including rural Mexico, Ecuador, and Tanzania.

An experience we had hiking up Mount Kilimanjaro in Tanzania changed our perspective. Tourists are required to use guides and